

Buddha Bumperstickers

The teacher's title is Buddha Bumperstickers. Alex makes two of them. Each one is a short written statement plus decoration in colored pen or pencil, on printer paper cut the long way. So it is a little writing and a lot of lettering and drawing. Below are seven slogan options built only on concepts the handout lists, so he can pick the two he likes and letter them.

1 Step 1: set up the paper

Use printer paper halved long-ways. Each half, with a statement and decorations, is one bumper sticker.

His to supply. Cut printer paper in half the long way. Each half is one sticker, so you need two halves. Turn each one sideways so it is wide and short like a real bumper sticker. Letter the words along the long side.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The handout's wording here is garbled. It says you "will use two pieces of printer paper which is halved long-ways (each half, with a statement and decorations you create, will represent one bumpersticker)." Two sheets halved gives four strips, but only two stickers are due, so any two strips work. Cutting one sheet also gives two strips and satisfies the same sentence.

Colored pens and/or pencils are named in the handout, so plain pencil alone is not the assignment. Any color counts.

2 Option 1: Karma

Turn one concept from the teacher's list into a short bumper sticker statement.

WRITE THIS • 33 WORDS

Slogan: GOOD DEEDS, BAD DEEDS. THEY PICK YOUR NEXT LIFE. Draw: a car rear view mirror with a road behind it, and a small sign on the road ahead that says NEXT LIFE.

- Karma

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The handout defines karma as "good deeds/bad deeds that determine rebirth." There is no judge or watcher in that definition, so the slogan stays on deeds deciding the next life.

3 Option 2: Reincarnation

Turn one concept from the teacher's list into a short bumper sticker statement.

WRITE THIS • 38 WORDS

Slogan: LIFE IS A LOOP, NOT A LINE. Draw: a road that curves all the way around into a circle. Put a baby at the bottom of the road and an old person further along the same road.

- Reincarnation

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Samsara was taken off this one. The handout defines Samsara as "the false world itself/the product of illusion," not the cycle of rebirth. Labeling a loop drawing Samsara would clash with the teacher's own definition, even though other books do use the word that way.

4 Option 3: The four statements about suffering

Turn one concept from the teacher's list into a short bumper sticker statement.

WRITE THIS · 22 WORDS

Slogan: LIFE HURTS. WANTING CAUSES IT. IT CAN STOP. Draw: a path made of eight stepping stones leading away toward a sunrise.

- The four statements about suffering
- Eight-fold path

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The handout's four lines are: life is suffering; the cause of suffering is desire or selfishness; suffering can be stopped; the way to end suffering is to follow the eight-fold path of Buddhism. The slogan is the first three. The eight stones are the fourth.

5 Option 4: Nirvana

Turn one concept from the teacher's list into a short bumper sticker statement.

WRITE THIS · 25 WORDS

Slogan: ONE DROP. ONE OCEAN. SAME WATER. Draw: a single raindrop falling into a big calm ocean, with small ripples spreading out where it lands.

- Nirvana
- Atman
- Brahman

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The handout defines Nirvana as the realization that Atman (the individual soul) and Brahman (the universal soul) are identical. The drop is Atman, the ocean is Brahman.

Heads up if it comes up in class: that is the Hindu version. Most Buddhist teaching denies a permanent individual soul, so a Buddhism textbook would define Nirvana differently. Alex should answer with the teacher's definition, since that is what this handout gives.

6 Option 5: Dharma

Turn one concept from the teacher's list into a short bumper sticker statement.

WRITE THIS · 32 WORDS

Slogan: DO YOUR OWN JOB WELL, NOT SOMEBODY ELSE'S. Draw: a three lane highway. One car sits calm and straight in its own lane while the other cars swerve across the lines.

- Dharma

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The handout lists Dharma but never defines it. It defines Kama, Artha and Moksha right next to it and leaves Dharma blank. This slogan uses the standard meaning: your own duty, the right way of living for your own role. That comes from general knowledge, not from the handout.

7 Option 6: Maya

Turn one concept from the teacher's list into a short bumper sticker statement.

WRITE THIS · 25 WORDS

Slogan: THE WORLD IS A MAGIC TRICK. Draw: a magician's hand lifting a top hat, with a small planet Earth floating up out of it.

- Maya
- Samsara

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Both labels fit here in the handout's own words. Maya is illusion, and it says the earth often represented Maya. Samsara is the false world that the illusion produces. That is why the Earth comes out of the hat.

8 Spare option: meditation

Only needed if he does not like two of the six above.

WRITE THIS · 25 WORDS

Slogan: SIT STILL. NOTHING IS ON FIRE. Draw: a person sitting cross legged on a cushion, with a flat calm line of water behind them.

- Yoga

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The handout defines Yoga as the process of meditation, which is what this sticker shows. Yogi was dropped from the labels because the handout defines a Yogi as a spiritual teacher or adviser, and there is no teacher in this drawing.

9 Step 2: pick two and finish them

Create two bumper stickers. Most importantly, HAVE FUN.

His to supply. Pick any two from the list. They do not have to match or go together. Letter the words first, color second, and put your name on the back of each one.

Gap. The handout has three example bumper stickers on page 2, but they are images and did not come through in the text. Have Alex look at them on his printed copy before choosing.

Gap. The printed instructions are cut off mid-sentence in two places, so the exact size and format of the two stickers is not fully knowable from the file.